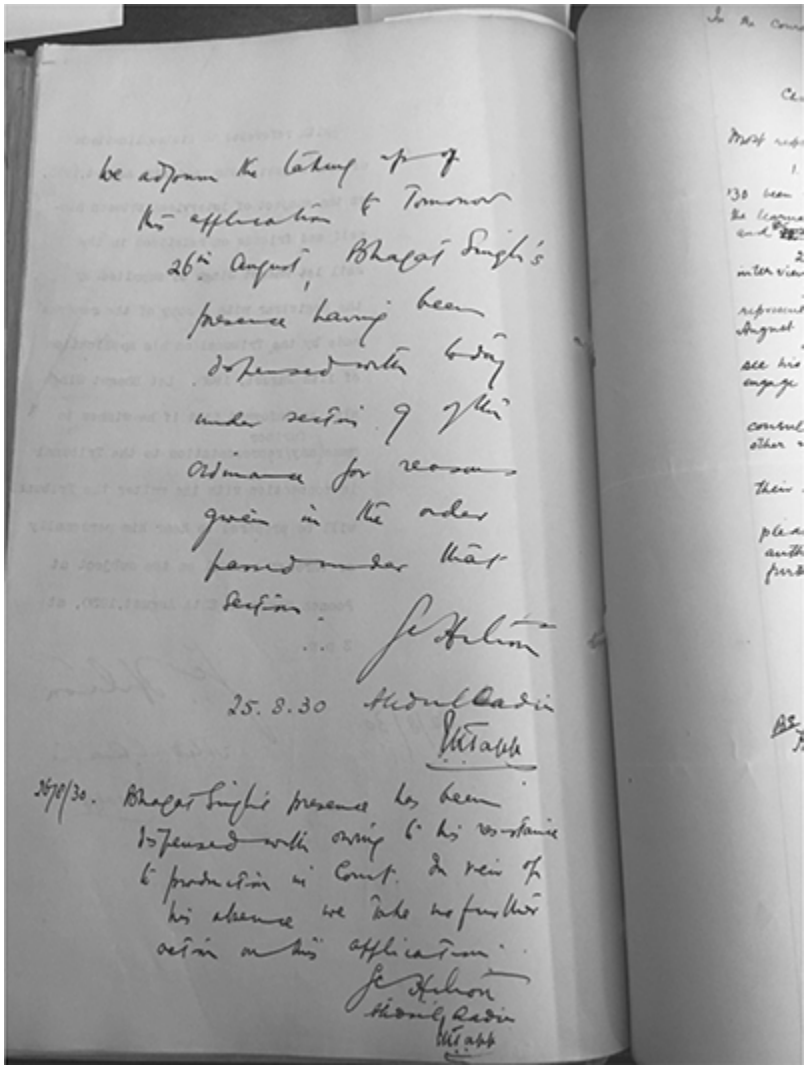


(16) Despite being already subject to a dispensation order by Justice Hilton on 25 August 1920, the following day Bhagat Singh is seen to be still complaining about the fact that ‘since the accused – petitioner – has not been given any opportunity to interview his relatives and particularly his father, who is the only person interested in his defence, he is not in a position to engage any Counsel or legal adviser, and without whose help he cannot decide anything regarding such a delicate matter as the defence’. It is clear that he is not voluntarily choosing to absent himself from the proceedings but is being forced out because he implores the judicial authorities ‘that the court be pleased to see if it is proper in the